



January 2nd 2018 Delaware County Commissioners Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0EvU9bd4-Fc
Publication Date	2018-01-02T19:15:10Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners: Reorganization Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: 2018 (Exact date not explicitly stated in the opening, though prior meeting minutes referenced are from December 18, 2017)

Board Name: Board of County Commissioners, Delaware County, Indiana

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the 2018 reorganization meeting to order at [00:00:07](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Henry, Mr. Riggins (Regan), and Mr. King.
 - **Absent:** None noted during roll call.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. King was subsequently elected as Board President.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance (00:00:11).
- **Board Leadership Elections (00:00:52):**
 - **President:** Mr. King nominated and elected as President (Roll call vote passed unanimously).
 - **Vice President:** Ms. Sherry Riggins nominated and elected as Vice President.
- **Annual Appointments (00:01:49):** The board adopted the list of 2018 annual recurring appointments (including Emergency Management Director, Medical Service Director, and County Attorney, with an update to the Category Development Commission). **Action:** Approved by voice vote.
- **Staggered-Term Appointments (00:02:52):** Individual and grouped board/commission appointments with 3- or 4-year terms were reviewed and approved:
 - *Airport Authority:* Run two small (4-year term)
 - *Board of Health:* Joe Russell and Dr. John Peterson
 - *Delaware County Planning Commission:* Tracy Hensley
 - *Delaware County Board of Zoning Appeals:* Joss Zimmerman
 - *Delaware County Fair Board:* Jane Laster, Donald Patterson, Melanie Marshall, Park Kiessling, and Linda Bratton
 - *Regional Liberty Wastewater:* Steve graves
 - **Action:** Approved by voice vote (00:04:30).
- **Tabled Business:** Resolution 2017-044 remained tabled (00:04:44).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the December 18, 2017 meeting were presented. **Action:** Approved by voice vote (00:04:59).
- **Contracts and Agreements:** Pending contracts were tabled to the January 16 meeting due to holiday scheduling constraints. **Action:** Approved to table by voice vote (00:05:26).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:39 Resolution Number 2018-001: Reimbursement of Expenditures Prior to Long-Term Financing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners / County administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This resolution serves as the initial procedural step required for refinancing and working on the jail project. It authorizes the reimbursement of certain expenditures made prior to issuing long-term financing.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (00:06:52, Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. Riggins: Yes, Mr. King: Yes).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:07:32 Jay Williams (Resident and Tattoo Studio Owner)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Expressed concerns over a recently passed county health ordinance governing body art. Specifically objected to the stipulation requiring *both* parents to be present or sign for a minor to receive a tattoo or piercing (stricter than the state requirement of one signature). Argued that it creates friction in blended/separated families, places unreasonable burdens on legal guardians, and risks driving minors toward unsafe, unregulated body art environments.
- **00:08:17 Jamie (Administrator, Health Department)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Responded to Mr. Williams' concerns by explaining that the local health board enacted stricter rules than the state baseline to protect minors. Clarified that a single legal guardian can sign if they have proper authority, though acknowledging the rule requires navigating complex domestic scenarios. Noted similar or stricter rules exist in neighboring counties like Madison County.
- **00:14:32 Mr. Mainland (Health Department Representative)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Supported the ordinance amendment, recounting past administrative complaints in Henry County involving non-custodial parents taking minors to get tattoos for superficial reasons. Noted that other tattoo shops in Delaware County had indicated willingness to comply and supported the measure.
- **00:17:43 Nate Harmon (Professional Tattoo Artist)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Spoke regarding the ordinance and broader industry issues. Criticized the decentralized county-by-county licensing fee structure in Indiana for tattoo artists compared to state-level unified occupational licenses (such as food handler permits), arguing that varying county fees create unfair working conditions and drive business out of the county. Inquired about the proper administrative pathway to request an ordinance amendment.
- **00:22:23 Procedural Guidance Provided to Public:** Commissioners and staff clarified that because the policy originates as a Department of Health ordinance, any requests for amendments must first be submitted to the **Board of Health** for a formal recommendation before coming before the Board of Commissioners.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None explicitly detailed, though a future meeting date of January 16 was referenced during the discussion on tabling contracts.
 - **Adjournment:** Following public comment, the board entertained a motion to recess/adjourn at **00:23:02**.
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